Lesson 9.1: Next.js App Router, server actions, edge functions and middleware

What you learn

- **App Router.** Folders define routes; layouts nest; server components run on the server by default.
- **Server actions.** Functions that run on the server and are called from forms or components. Validate input and check the user inside them.
- **Edge functions and middleware.** Run close to the user before a request completes: redirects, auth checks, headers. Keep them small.
- **Security.** Treat every server action as a public endpoint.

Tools and resources (official sites, not checked live)

- Next.js App Router

ASSIGNMENT

Practice for lesson 9.1

Business problem: Protect a route.

Steps

1. Add middleware that redirects signed-out users from /account.
2. Add a server action with validation.
3. Test both.

Expected output: Signed-out requests redirect; invalid input is rejected.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

Middleware checks a session cookie and redirects. The action validates input again because it is a public endpoint.

Check yourself

1. Are server actions private?
   Answer: No; validate and authorise each call.
2. What is middleware for?
   Answer: Work that must happen before the page, such as redirects.

Lesson 9.1 of the **Development and IT** lessons. See this lesson and its official links on skillnavora.in · All chapters and lessons · Open the full lesson guide. Tools, prices and plans change; confirm on each official site.